

Gautam Velpula

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Dear Hiring Team,

I'm writing to express my strong interest in the Vice President of Product Engineering role for Tax, Accounting, and Audit Professionals at Thomson Reuters. The opportunity to lead a major portfolio transformation while shaping AI-enabled products that professionals rely on every day is exactly the kind of work I find most meaningful—and where my experience maps most directly.

At GoTo Foods, I own end-to-end engineering responsibility for a portfolio of mission-critical product lines across digital ordering, payments, subscriptions, and marketing technology. The challenge I inherited is one I suspect will feel familiar: multiple independent product platforms, built separately over time, that needed to be converged into a unified, API-led architecture without disrupting the business. I led that transformation—consolidating 7 brand platforms into a shared architecture, modernizing from monolithic legacy systems to microservices, and establishing the operating rigor across delivery, quality, security, and reliability that makes it sustainable. The result was a 40% reduction in time-to-market and a 30% improvement in system uptime.

What excites me about this role is that it goes beyond running delivery. Three areas of alignment stand out:

Product partnership, not just engineering execution. I work shoulder-to-shoulder with Product leadership to shape roadmap and prioritization—not as a downstream recipient of requirements, but as a partner who brings technical insight to product strategy. I've incubated new product offerings, influenced go-to-market decisions, and helped the business see possibilities that weren't on the original roadmap.

AI with real customer impact. I'm currently leading our AI strategy across the portfolio—generative AI, intelligent automation, and agentic experiences embedded in production products and internal workflows. I've defined the architectural patterns and responsible AI governance that make this safe and scalable, partnering with security and compliance to get it right. This isn't exploratory work; it's shipping capabilities that customers and engineers use daily.

Building global teams and leaders. I've built engineering organizations across multiple geographies throughout my career—from scaling a global services team at Jacada, to directing distributed delivery at Slalom, to leading a senior architecture organization at GoTo Foods. I know how to raise technical standards, grow leadership bench strength, and create operating mechanisms that work across time zones and organizational boundaries.

I'm drawn to Thomson Reuters because of the scale and significance of the work. Tax and compliance software is mission-critical in the truest sense—professionals stake their reputations on it. That demands engineering excellence, and it demands a leader who takes that responsibility seriously. I'd welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can contribute.

Sincerely,
Gautam Velpula